A Favourable Climate for Action

KABIR CHANDRAKAR, 29
Farmer

Lok Sabha constituency: Raipur, Chhattisgarh

What will influence his vote: Economic policy, ability to lead India in a tumultuous world, PM face, climate change policy



BHUPESH KESHARWANI

Chhattisgarh resident Kabir Chandrakar's farmer parents were keen that he acquire an education so that he could get a good job. But Chandrakar's heart was set on farming and, after getting an MBA degree from England, he returned to India, to pursue progressive farming. To add to his family's 45-acre farmland, the 30-year-old took more land on lease, and today farms around 120 acres. Most of this is a guava plantation, except two acres on which he grows mangoes. No wonder the resident of Mujgahan village in Raipur district wants political parties to have policies that are beneficial for farmers. "Economic progress is key to the country's future and I will vote for a party that comes up with a better plan for economic development," he says. He also wants future governments to address the issue of climate change. "In Chhattisgarh, governments are offering inflated price for paddy. This is leading to monoculture, which will eventually have a negative effect," he says. Come May 7, and Chandrakar will exercise his vote, as Raipur goes to the polls. ■

"Government policy should be tailored to address climate change"

-Rahul Noronha



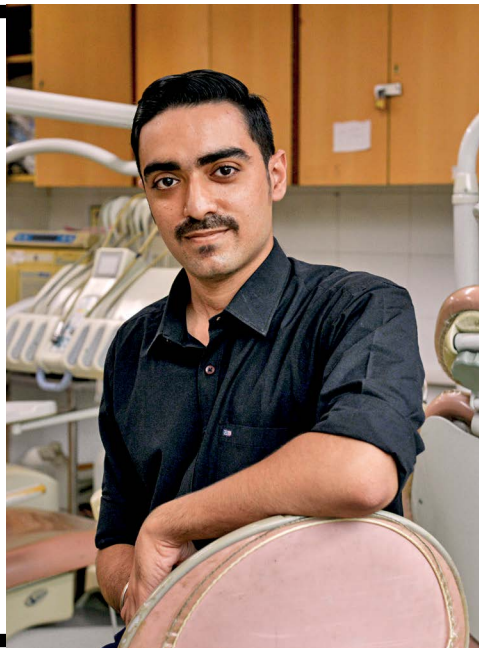
Making Her Vote Count

Twenty-three-year-old Patna resident Farah Naz will cast her vote for Parliament for the first time on June 1, but exhibits an astute understanding of national politics. She maintains a non-partisan stance in politics, but stresses on the importance of every vote. "Every vote counts. Societal change hinges on the collective choices affirmed through voting," says Farah, who has previously voted for the Bihar as-

NO IDENTITY POLITICS

There may have been a phase when the youth in the country were disconnected from politics, feels Delhi student Khushal Makhija, but that is not the case today, he says. The 24-year-old admits that the 2024 election—Delhi votes in the sixth phase on May 25—is a subject of conversation among his friends, with the talk revolving around national development, opportunities for students and the alleged misuse of central agencies by the current government. Makhija himself has strong views on the action being taken by the Enforcement Directorate against members of the Opposition. He says, "If I had to choose between Rahul [Gandhi] and [Prime Minister

"Reconsidering reservation, especially in postgraduation courses, should be a priority for the next government"



YASIR IQBAL